



C&E FAMILY
HONORARY APPOINTMENTS

REFERENCES:

- A. CFAO 3-4
- B. CAO 11-09
- C. AFO 5002-0
- D. CDS Letter dated 30 July 2016 – CAF HONORARY APPOINTMENTS PROGRAM – MND'S APPRECIATION AND VISION: GENDER PARITY
- E. COS IM Letter dated 6 October 2017 – DIVERSITY AND GENDER PARITY ASSISTANT DEPUTY MINISTER INFORMATION MANAGEMENT HONORARY APPOINTMENTS

INTRODUCTION

The Canadian tradition of honorary appointments to units originated with the British military but only been in practice in Canada for little over a century. The first Honorary Colonel appointment in Canada was that of the Honorable J.M. Gibson, a Provincial Secretary in the Ontario government. He was appointed as Honorary Lieutenant-Colonel to the 13th Battalion of Infantry in 1895. The Honorary appointment is seen to be the guardian of unit traditions and history, promoting the unit's identity and ethos and being an advisor to the Commanding Officer on virtually all matters excluding operations.

Within the C&E Family there are several organizations that have Honorary and they include:

- Canadian Army
- RCAF
- CJOC
- IM Group

POTENTIAL ROLES AND DUTIES

Some of the potential duties for Honorary appointees include:

- fostering esprit de corps;
- promoting the Unit's interest in the local community;
- developing, promoting, and sustaining strong community support for the Unit;
- observing and advising on protocol;
- establishing and maintaining liaison with Unit charities and associations;
- providing counsel, advice and such assistance as is appropriate to Unit personnel;
- assisting the Unit in hosting parades and other Unit functions; and

- carrying out other duties or providing advice in matters where they are qualified through their back- ground, knowledge and area of expertise.

SELECTION CRITERIA

The criteria set out below are some but not all of the factors that should be considered when nominating an individual for an Honorary appointment – keeping in mind that an Honorary appointment is an appointment by the Minister of National Defence. Nominations should reflect the cultural, gender and ethnic makeup of the unit and Canada as a whole. Honorary appointments should be individuals who can further the interests of our C&E Family. Suggested criteria are as follows:

- Influential in the community, and other circles of influence (businesses, universities, etc).
- Appreciation for and support of the role of the Canadian Armed Forces in Canada and internationally.
- Alignment with goals for the security and defence of Canada;
- Career experience of interest to the unit;
- Mentoring experience and capability;
- Ability to Connect with Canadians through a network of influential contacts and through opportunities to address local community and other audiences;
- Ability to have frequent presence at the unit location and frequent contact with the unit commander and personnel;
- Fit enough to participate in field events and visits.
- Articulate, inspirational and a leader.
- Keen enthusiasm for the members of the Branch, and the greater C&E family – Association, Museum, Cadets, etc.

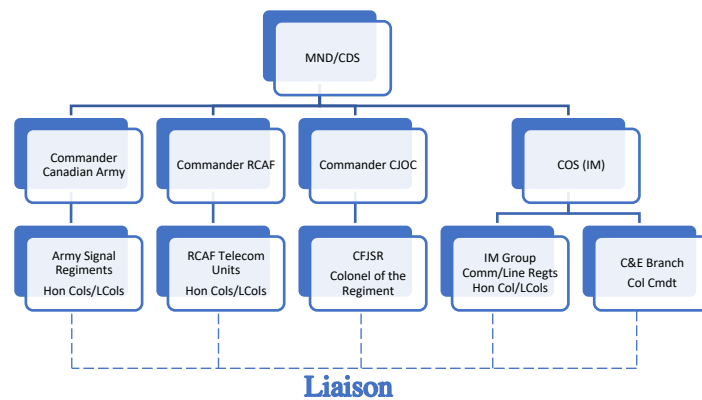
SELECTION PROCESS

The References cited describe the selection process for Honorary appointments within the CAF and the Canadian Army and the RCAF. Appropriate attention will be paid to References D and E – CDS's and former COS IM's guidance related to diversity and gender parity in the identification of potential nominees. The selection of Honorary appointments remains the responsibility of the relevant military command authority. However, it is important that the C&E Family Senate – representing the entire C&E Family – has visibility in the selection of those individuals who will be nominated for Honorary appointments for C&E Branch units. Therefore, the C&E Family Senate should be engaged for advice on the nomination of those individuals who are being proposed for Honorary appointments for the Army, RCAF, CJOC and IM Group C&E units before they are submitted to the appropriate chain of command for further staffing and approval.

Unit Commanding Officer are requested to provide the C&E Family Senate through the Branch Office the names of the individuals who are being considered for such appointments. Correspondence regarding the nomination will be provided as 'Honours In Confidence' and submitted in sufficient time to ensure that there is no delay staffing by the appropriate authorities. Note – such consideration by the C&E Senate is not intended to subvert the chain of command. But it is appropriate that Honorary appointment nominations within the C&E Family should have visibility with the C&E Family leadership.

RELATIONSHIP – C&E BRANCH HONORARY APPOINTMENTS

It is accepted practice that the C&E Branch Colonel Commandant will have direct involvement with the C&E Branch Honorary appointments. While this is not a hierarchical relationship the Col Cmdt will be considered first among equals within the C&E Branch Honorary community. This relationship will allow discussions that are specific to the C&E Branch to occur among the C&E Honorary community. The Col Cmdt will on a regular basis convene discussions among the C&E Honorary appointments with the intention of a formal annual gathering centred on the C&E week in October. These discussions will provide the C&E Honorary appointments to understand, reflect on and enhance C&E Branch' capacity to better serve Canada and the CAF.



CONCLUSION

The selection of Honorary appointments is an important and high-profile endeavour within the CAF. It recognizes the long-standing tradition where individuals are selected as guardians of unit traditions and history. It is imperative that those individuals nominated for such positions within the C&E Branch reflect the values and ethos of our C&E family. The ultimate goal is that these individuals will enhance the unity, pride and esprit de corps of the C&E Branch. The C&E Family Senate is the appropriate body for such deliberations and as such will be engaged in advising on nominations of those individuals for this important role within our C&E military family.